In the tight-knit, multi-generational power structure of mid-century San Francisco, **Erna (Irma) Riese** influenced her nephew **Chapman Riese** through two specific levers: **social patronage** and **real estate succession**.

1. Social Patronage & the SFPD Promotion Track
While Chapman's father, **Caspar**, provided the direct line to the San Francisco Police Department, Erna provided the **social "polish"** required for a Lieutenant to move into the city's upper-tier civic circles.

- **The Cave Man Connection:** As the wife of a Cave Man camp member, Erna hosted the social gatherings where SFPD leadership rubbed shoulders with the city's elite.
- **Recommendation Power:** In the 1950s and 60s, a "nod" from a Cave Man's wife at a private club—like the Century Club of California—could subtly fast-track a relative's reputation among the Police Commission and the Mayor's office.

2. Real Estate Stewardship & The "Family Trust"
Erna was a central figure in the **Thomas J. Riese** and **Wallis Sr.** real estate trusts.

- **Financial Gatekeeper:** As a co-trustee or beneficiary of the family's San Francisco holdings, Erna influenced Chapman's financial stability. In many "Old San Francisco" families, the matriarch controlled the distribution of family assets that allowed younger members like Chapman to maintain a "high-society" lifestyle (such as Notre Dame tuition or homes in the Richmond/Sunset districts) on a civil servant's salary.
- **Property Placement:** Erna often decided which family properties were managed by whom. If Chapman or his son **Christopher** were involved in the family's real estate brokerage, Erna's approval of the "trustee" list was the final word.

3. The "Irma" Factor in Legal Records
Because Erna (Irma) and **Thomas J. Riese** (Tom) often appeared together on **deeds and probate filings**, she was the "legal anchor" for the family.

- **Influence through Succession:** When **Wallis Sr.** died in 1965, Erna became the primary holder of the family's Bohemian Club social legacy. She ensured that the family's connections—including Chapman's access to elite networks—remained intact during the transition of power to the next generation (Tom and Ernie).

Grave Locations for the "Inner Circle"

- **Erna, Wallis Sr., & Tom Riese:** All interred at Mount Tamalpais Cemetery in San Rafael.
- **Chapman & Caspar Riese:** Interred at Holy Cross Catholic Cemetery in Colma.
- **Ernie Riese (d. 1973):** Often buried in the Cypress Lawn or **Holy Cross** family plots, acting as the bridge between the SFPD side (Caspar) and the Cave Man side (Wallis).